



IEEE Access - Decision on Manuscript ID Access-2026-34747

1 message

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Reply to: alba.amato@ieee.org
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Cc: alba.amato@ieee.org, albaamato@gmail.com

Wed, 19 Aug 2026 at 10:11

19-Aug-2026

Dear Dr. MGTHUSHARA:

Your manuscript entitled "An Interpretable Deterministic Framework for Cross-Language Educational Code Similarity Using Code Property Graphs" has been accepted for publication in IEEE Access. The comments of the reviewers who evaluated your manuscript are included at the foot of this letter. We ask that you make minor changes to your manuscript based on those comments, before uploading final files.

Please be advised that you are **not permitted** to add or remove authors or references post-acceptance, regardless of the reviewers' request(s). **Any request to add an author post-acceptance will be denied.** However, we encourage you to check the formatting of your references to ensure that they are accurate in terms of bibliographic details as well as consistent with [IEEE style](#). Additionally, please take this opportunity to improve the English grammar and check spelling, as the article is only lightly edited before publication.

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Once you have completed the submission of your final files, the **accepted version** of your article will be posted Early Access on IEEE *Xplore* within 2-3 business days. Within 7-10 business days the corresponding author will receive your page proofs, at which point you can make **minor** edits as necessary. Once the corresponding author approves the proofs, the final version will replace the Early Access version on IEEE *Xplore*.

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Thank you for your fine contribution. On behalf of the Editors of IEEE Access, we look forward to your continued contributions to IEEE Access.

Sincerely,

Dr. Alba Amato
Associate Editor, IEEE Access
alba.amato@ieee.org, albaamato@gmail.com

Reviewer(s)' Comments to Author:

Reviewer: 1

Comments:
Nice research work

Additional Questions:
Please confirm that you have reviewed all relevant files, including supplementary files and any author response files, which can be found in the "View Author's Response" link above (author responses will only appear for resubmissions): Yes, all files have been reviewed

- 1) Does the paper contribute to the body of knowledge?: Yes
- 2) Is the paper technically sound?: Yes
- 3) Is the subject matter presented in a comprehensive manner?: Yes
- 4) Are the references provided applicable and sufficient?: Yes
- 5) Are there references that are not appropriate for the topic being discussed?: No
- 5a) If yes, then please indicate which references should be removed.:

Reviewer: 2

Comments:

Thank you for the resubmission. The system works, the repository is live, and the limitations are stated. My concerns relate to reporting accuracy and evaluation design.

- 1) Table 10's cells sum to 349/400 (87.25%), which means that the n=11 and n=3 cases are included in the aggregate. Please either report the corrected aggregate (342/386 = 88.60%) or withdraw the exclusion claim.
- 2) Corpus filtering reduces the zero-CES rate from 23.25% to 0.25%, introducing a potential selection bias that is not discussed in the validity analysis. Please report baseline results on the unfiltered corpus.
- 3) No single-view ablation is provided. Given Table 8's optimum weights (0.00, 0.05, 0.95), the contribution of the structural view remains unclear. Please report BL-only, WL-only, and CES-only results.
- 4) The reported 64% adversarial floor combines incompatible sample sizes (n=93 and n=60). Please recompute.
- 5) TF-IDF is an internal component of the framework, making the McNemar comparison an ablation rather than an independent baseline. Please clarify this distinction or compare against an external IR baseline.
- 6) Phase 1 provides the fusion weights, taxonomy, and 88.5% baseline but is neither cited nor sufficiently described. Please provide enough detail for this paper to stand on its own.

Additional Questions:

Please confirm that you have reviewed all relevant files, including supplementary files and any author response files, which can be found in the "View Author's Response" link above (author responses will only appear for resubmissions): Yes, all files have been reviewed

- 1) Does the paper contribute to the body of knowledge?: Partially. The Context Normalization Protocol is a genuine contribution, but the interpretability claim is unsupported. No user study is presented, and the zero-CES fallback path yields no pattern inventory despite being scored as a correct retrieval.
- 2) Is the paper technically sound?: No. Table 10's directional cells sum to 349/400 (87.25%), indicating that the n=11 and n=3 cells remain in the aggregate despite claims otherwise. Also, filtering reduces the zero-CES rate from 23.25% to 0.25%, introducing a potential selection bias not covered in the validity threats.
- 3) Is the subject matter presented in a comprehensive manner?: Partially. The method and validity analysis are good, but no ablation isolates the three fused views. Table 8's optimum weights (0.00, 0.05, 0.95) also suggest limited contribution from the structural view.
- 4) Are the references provided applicable and sufficient?: Partially. The Phase 1 study on which this work relies for its fusion weights, 9-pattern taxonomy, and 88.5% baseline is discussed only as "our previous research" and "the original manuscript" and is not formally cited.
- 5) Are there references that are not appropriate for the topic being discussed?: No
- 5a) If yes, then please indicate which references should be removed.:

If you have any questions, please contact article administrator: Mr. Shri Krishna Mishra k.mishra@ieee.org



* Final-Files-Checklist.docx

133 KB